

GUIDANCE NOTES FOR APPLICANTS

These Guidance Notes complement the Invitation to Tender and are designed to help with completing the Application Form.

APPLICATION PROCESS

All applications will be treated in confidence.

The application process for this Contracts for Innovation Cymru competition requires the completion of the online Application Form on the Simply Do Innovation Portal. Whilst a downloadable copy is available on the portal, all applications must be submitted digitally.

Before submitting, it is the lead applicant's responsibility to make sure:

- that all the information provided in the application is correct
- your proposal meets the eligibility and scope criteria
- all sections of the application are marked as complete

The form should be completed and submitted as directed. We strongly advise that these accompanying Guidance Notes are read prior to submission.

You must submit the application before the competition deadline.

The application process closes at - [see challenge brief](#)

Please do not send completed applications by post or by any other means than as directed.

If you experience any difficulties or wish to seek additional clarification, please contact ContractsforInnovationCymru@wales.nhs.uk

If you experience any difficulties with the sell2wales website please contact the helpdesk on 08445610672

GUIDANCE ON COMPLETING THE APPLICATION FORM

These notes should be read in conjunction with the application form and are designed to help you to provide the information required. **The application form has a fixed length for the answer to each question; if you enter text that is not visible within the cell, or submit appendices that exceed the set maximum length, it will not be read or assessed.**

The application form should be completed using a font size no smaller than 10 (Arial). Keep the use of acronyms to a minimum. Only use acronyms where a term is mentioned

frequently throughout the proposal. If you do choose to use an acronym, do not assume that the reader knows what it means, and be sure to define it, bearing in mind that individual sections of the application may be read separately during the assessment process.

In order for your application to be accepted you must submit all the required information. This includes all mandatory fields from the application form and failure to complete these fields will result in your application being rejected on the grounds that it is incomplete.

Guidance on the individual sections of the application form is provided below:

Idea Name

Name your idea based on the problem it solves or the solution it provides.

A) APPLICATION

This section provides background for your application and is not scored.

1. Project Title (Mandatory)

Please provide the title for the project. This should be both clearly descriptive and concise. It should contain keywords relevant to the project.

2. Contract Duration (months) (Mandatory) – See Challenge Brief for full details

The maximum allowable project length is 5 months from the start of the project.

3. Total Contract Cost (£s) (Mandatory) - See Challenge Brief for details

Proposed projects can tender for a maximum contract cost as noted on the challenge brief (contract value including VAT). Requests for more than these defined amounts at each stage of the competition **will be rejected.**

4. What is the best way to describe your Innovation? (Please select from available options) (Mandatory)

B) DETAILS OF LEAD APPLICANT ORGANISATION

Company Details (Mandatory)

Please submit the Company name, and other details as requested on the Application Form.

C) CONTACT DETAILS

Contact Details (Mandatory)

Please submit the lead applicant's name, post held, company name, position etc. Lead applicants are expected before submitting applications, to have discussed their proposals with their own company or any other body whose co-operation will be required in the conduct of the project. By submitting the application, you are confirming that the information given, in this application, is complete and that you are actively engaged in this project and responsible for its overall management and agree to administer the award if made.

In addition, please provide details of where you heard about the competition by selecting from the available options.

All sections from section D) onwards will be scored by assessors.

D) YOUR SOLUTION

QUESTION 1. PUBLIC FACING ELEVATOR PITCH

Please provide a brief 'Dragon's Den' style public facing elevator pitch of your project.

(250 words)

Please provide a brief, "public facing" description of the project. Be clear about what makes it innovative and how it relates to the scope of the competition. How does it tackle different aspects of the challenge and how will it provide an integrated solution?

Should your project be successful, this information will be made public once the award is confirmed. Do not include any commercially confidential information in this section. We reserve the right to amend the description before publication, if necessary, but will consult you about any changes.

QUESTION 2. VIDEO ELEVATOR PITCH

Please record and submit a video pitch (via the Simply Do platform) summarising the following:

- What your solution is and what makes it innovative
- The benefits it will deliver
- Why your project should be funded.

Maximum of 3 minutes in total

QUESTION 3. PROPOSED TECHNOLOGY OR PROCESS.

How does the project meet the challenge described in the competition scope?

(1000 words)

Describe:

- your proposed technology or process.
- current state of development.
- The proposed benefits.

Avoiding the use of unnecessary technical jargon, describe clearly how it will deliver the outcomes as described in the competition documentation. In particular describe the benefits that will accrue to UK householders and businesses. What evidence have you acquired to support your claims?

This question will be scored against this assessment criterion:

- How well does the proposal meet the challenge?
- Does the supplier demonstrate an understanding of the challenge Brief and detail the full benefits?

QUESTION 4. TECHNICAL PROJECT SUMMARY

What are the main technical challenges you are addressing?

(750 words)

Explain:

- how you will address the challenge
- what the innovation is
- the main technical deliverables
- the research and development that will prove the scientific, environmental and commercial merit of the project
- what might be achieved by deploying the innovation to address the selected challenge

This question will be scored against this assessment criterion:

- How valid is the technical approach?
- If the proposal delivers what it says it is going to deliver, will it enhance care e.g. safety, compassion etc.

- How positively does the solution impact the outlined problem and benefit the end user(s)?
- Has the supplier sufficiently described the technical deliverables and is the R&D approach suitably robust?

QUESTION 5. CURRENT STATE OF THE ART AND INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

What is the current level of innovation and what novel concepts will this project deliver?

(750 words)

Are similar products currently available in the market?

How is your proposed project differentiated from them?

You must include details of:

- any existing intellectual property (IP)
- its significance to your freedom to operate
- novel concepts you develop or employ
- new approaches or technologies you use
- new tools or technologies

This question will be scored against these assessment criteria: 'How innovative is this project? How much does the project develop or employ novel concepts, approaches, methodologies, tools or technologies for this area?'.

E) READINESS AND PROJECT PLAN:

QUESTION 1. PROJECT PLAN AND METHODOLOGY

Describe your project plan and identify the main milestones.

(750 words)

The plan must be comprehensive. The emphasis throughout should be on practicality.

You must:

- describe resources that will be needed to deliver the project
- describe what the main success criteria will be

- identify the project management processes that will ensure you achieve the milestones
- provide a clear plan with identified milestones
- explain how you would handle any intellectual property (IP) issues which might arise during the project.
- include details of how you will maintain freedom to operate and fulfil the IP requirements detailed in the contract if you are working with subcontractors.

Your milestones must:

- be clear
- be defined using SMART (specific, measurable, achievable, realistic and time-bound) criteria
- be associated with the appropriate deliverables and payments
- indicate your payment schedule by month
- Include clear stage-gates / “Go/No go” points

This question will be assessed against these assessment criteria:

- Are the timeframes realistic and will their proposal complete by the deadline date?
- Is there a clear management plan?
- Are the milestones and evaluation procedures appropriate?

Please note information from the finances section will be used to support the assessment of this question. Proposed milestones and associated payments stated in this section must match those entered in the finance summary on your application.

QUESTION 1A. PROJECT PLAN AND METHODOLOGY

Upload of project plan

- Please upload your project plan (in the form of a Gantt chart)
- Please only upload a singular file in this section
- Please upload in PDF format no larger than 10MB and up to 2 A4 pages. The font must be legible at 100% zoom

QUESTION 2. RISKS AND MITIGATION

What are the key technical, commercial and environmental risks you foresee in the delivery of this project?

(750 words)

List risks and issues that you anticipate with this project and any activities you can undertake to reduce their impact on the successful outcome of your project.

Think about them with the following headings; Project Management, Material, Resources, Staffing, Patient Safety and Other. Scoring the risks in a Red, Amber, Green format (High, Medium and Low).

This question will be assessed against these assessment criteria:

- Does the proposal provide you with enough assurance that there is no detriment to the safety of the user or that it improves it (e.g 5=improves safety 0=detrimental to safety)?
- Have all appropriate risks been identified and has the supplier provided you with sufficient information to provide confidence that they will be adequately mitigated?

QUESTION 3. TECHNICAL TEAM AND EXPERTISE

Please tell us about your delivery team, their relevant expertise including relevant recognised professional qualifications and any memberships of Chartered Institutions and the time that they will be spending on this project.

(750 words)

Who is in the technical team? What expertise do they offer?

Provide a brief description of your technical team, including any subcontractors.

Describe:

- how each organisation has the skills, capabilities, and experience to deliver the intended benefits
- how much of their time will be spent on the project

This question will be scored against this assessment criterion: 'Does the applicant have the skills, capabilities and experience to deliver the intended benefits?'.

QUESTION 4. READINESS

Please detail your current state of readiness in order to deliver this project within the dates outlined in the challenge brief (including sourcing equipment and resources).

(750 words)

Detail current commitment to the project and how quickly resources can commence work. Also include access to sourcing and availability of any relevant equipment.

This question will be scored against this assessment criterion: 'Does the application provide sufficient confidence that the project can be delivered within the required timescales?'

F) TESTING:

QUESTION 1. TESTING

Provide a brief description of how you will provide assurance that your solution will be fit for purpose.

(750 words)

Describe:

- testing requirements
- evaluation process
- specialist support

This question will be scored against this assessment criterion: 'Does the application provide sufficient confidence that the testing/evaluation approach outlined within the proposal is robust? Does it provide adequate assurance?'

G) ACCESSIBILITY & WELSH LANGUAGE COMPLIANCE

Creating accessible opportunities aligns with the principles of the Well-being of Future Generations (Wales) Act 2015. The act emphasises the importance of long term thinking and aims to improve the social, economic, environmental, and cultural wellbeing of Wales. In addition to this, Wales is a bilingual nation and Welsh language considerations must form an integral part of project design and delivery. Applicants should consider Welsh language, accessibility and equitable access together throughout the project, recognising the diverse needs of service users, communities and professionals across Wales.

Please indicate (using Yes, No or Not Applicable), will your organisation ensure that the proposed solution is accessible, inclusive, and available to users in both Welsh and English throughout the project (e.g. design and testing) and beyond, where applicable? If No, or not applicable, please explain why.

If responding yes, please describe how your organisation will demonstrate the following:

- Any planned accessibility improvements during the project period.
- How Welsh-speaking users will be able to access and use the solution.

This question will be scored against this assessment criterion: 'Has accessibility and Welsh Language been considered, and is the response to the question appropriate for the intended use of the solution and in line with Welsh Language standards? I.e., if answer no, suitable justification has been provided.'

If external expertise is required for translation, these costs should be built into the overall project costs in Section H.

H) FINANCE:

QUESTION 1. COSTS AND VALUE FOR MONEY

Please provide a summary and justification of your project costs (including VAT)

(750 words)

How much will the project cost? How does it represent value for money for the team and the taxpayer?

Describe:

- the total costs inclusive of VAT (If applicable) you are requesting in terms of the project goals
- how this project represents value for money for you and the taxpayer

All costs quoted must reflect actual costs at a 'fair market value' and not include profit.

The assessors are required to judge the application finances in terms of value for money. They will score your finances against this assessment criterion: 'Do you feel that the requested funding in the application provides good value for money against the work that they are going to carry out? Are the budget and costs realistic, justified and appropriate for the aims and methods?'

QUESTION 2. PAYMENT SCHEDULE

Please provide a Payment Schedule for your project costs. The schedule must also detail subcontractor costs.

(750 words)

Payment will be made on completion of agreed deliverables with 20% of total project cost being held on completion of project and production of project closure report. If there are any reasons why this arrangement is not suitable to your circumstances, outline these on the application form along with a desired payment schedule.

Consideration will be given to this during the assessment process, and whilst the inclusion of a staged payment may be authorised, there will be no circumstances where full payment will be made in advance. Proposed costs stated in this section must match those entered in the finance summary

Proposed costs stated in this section must match those entered in Section H, question 1 on your application.

QUESTION 3. DETAILS OF PREVIOUS INNOVATION FUNDING

Provide details of any other innovation funding that you have received for this innovation/solution.

(750 words)

Provide details of the funding source, the purpose of the funding (i.e. the funded project). Provide details of the specific differences in deliverables and what specific additions that this project will bring.

I) SOCIAL VALUE:

The Well-being of Future Generations (Wales) Act 2015 requires public bodies in Wales to think about the long-term impact of their decisions, to work better with people, communities and each other, and to prevent persistent problems such as poverty, health inequalities and climate change.

QUESTION 1. LONG TERM WELLBEING

How your organisation will help Welsh Government to improve the long-term wellbeing of people and communities in Wales?

(500 words)

Provide details of which [Well-being Goals](#) your work will support and provide examples.

QUESTION 2. WELSH ECONOMY

How will your organisation support the Welsh economy during this contract, including using local suppliers, creating local opportunities and delivering wider benefits for communities in Wales?

(500 words)

QUESTION 3. CARBON FOOTPRINT AND ENVIRONMENTAL IMPACT

What steps is your organisation taking to reduce its carbon footprint and environmental impact?

(500 words)

Please describe your current activities and future plans, including any targets or commitments.

These questions will be scored against the following assessment criteria:

‘How will the applicant deliver measurable economic, social, environmental and cultural benefits for Wales, beyond the core requirements of the contract?’

J) COMMERCIALISATION:

QUESTION 1. COMMERCIAL POTENTIAL

Please describe how you plan to commercialise your product, expanding on how your project is unique within the market place, also to include any partners you will be working with, and any additional funding streams.

(750 words)

What is the commercial potential of your project? You must focus on your proposed customer’s needs.

Describe your:

- timescales
- projects commercial potential for a marketable product, process or service, with a key focus on affordability to end user
- delivery plan
- your current marketing strategy
- potential to rapidly scale up your solution to cover wider markets
- competitive advantage that your project has over existing or alternative solutions that meet market needs.
- any existing commercial relationships relevant to the project.
- future commercial potential across the public or private sector and international markets with the focus on your proposed customer’s needs.

This question will be scored against these assessment criteria:

'Are you confident that the business has detailed how they are going to get their product onto the market after this Project, including finance, funding streams and additional partners?' This will include the following considerations:

- is there a clear commercial potential for a marketable product, process or service
- is there a clear plan to deliver that and a clear marketing strategy
- how significant is the competitive advantage of this technology over existing technologies that meet the market's needs

'If project is successful and we wanted to purchase, would the solution be available in a timely manner to suit the needs of the challenge?'

QUESTION 2. FINANCIAL VIABILITY

Please provide detail of value for money to public sector in Wales, along with any potential favourable terms for project participants and future Welsh customers.

(750 words)

This question will be scored against these assessment criteria: 'Does the solution look like it could be financially viable following completion of the Project, including any preferential terms?'

SUPPORTING INFORMATION.

BACKGROUND AND FURTHER INFORMATION

ABOUT CONTRACTS FOR INNOVATION COMPETITIONS

More information about the Contracts for Innovation programme can be found on the Innovate UK website: [Contracts for Innovation - Innovate UK Business Connect](#)

Contracts for Innovation competitions are open to all eligible organisations that can demonstrate a route to market for their solution. Under current regulations, contracts are open to applications from organisations registered in the UK, European Union (EU) and the European Economic Area (EEA).

Contracts for Innovation is the procurement of R&D services. If successful, you will receive a contract to deliver the proposed activity. Costs quoted must reflect actual costs at a 'fair market value' and not include profit.

If you are VAT registered, your total costs are expected to include VAT that you would charge as a service provider. VAT is the responsibility of the invoicing business, and applications are expected to list total costs inclusive of VAT.

Suppliers for each project will be selected by an open competition process and retain the intellectual property generated from the project, with certain rights of use retained by the contracting authority. This is an excellent opportunity to establish an early customer for a new technology and to fund its development.

NEXT STEPS

We will carry out checks to make sure you are an established company with access to the funds necessary to complete the project.

Please respond promptly to any requests for additional information to avoid any delays. We will also review your milestones, which, if not suitable, will need to be amended during project setup.

YOUR CONTRACT

A standard Contracts for Innovation contract will be issued which you will need to sign and return before you start your project, and this must be completed within 30 days of being notified your application was successful.

Your contract will show the start date for your project, do not start your project before this date. Any costs incurred before your start date cannot be claimed as part of your contract.

IF YOUR APPLICATION IS UNSUCCESSFUL

If you are unsuccessful with your application this time, you will be notified via email. Feedback can be requested.

Sometimes your application will have scored well, and you will receive positive comments from the assessors. You may be unsuccessful as your average score was not above the funding threshold or your project has not been selected under the portfolio approach which is being applied to this challenge.